

Philipp Hilbert. *Product manager who turns onboarding friction into activation.*

Positioning, ten years of B2B SaaS product ownership, now focused on the self-serve journey where data, experimentation, and customer empathy compound fastest.

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§ WHY CUSTOMER.IO

Customer.io sits at the intersection of behavioral data and automated messaging, a space where the product itself is the proof of what good activation looks like. The role centers on the self-serve motion: signup to activation to upgrade, with real experimentation muscle and cross-functional partners rather than a backlog owned by committee. The detail that caught my attention is the explicit weight on customer empathy over dashboard interpretation, finding what is actually slowing customers down, not just what the funnel numbers suggest. *That is exactly the discovery discipline I have built my career on.*

§ AI-NATIVE STACK

Daily tools, not buzzwords.

- **Claude Code**, in-repo prototyping and spec generation
- **Lovable**, rapid front-end mockups and throwaway prototypes
- **Framer**, design-heavy concept work
- **Cursor**, assisted code review and LLM-augmented debugging
- **GitHub Copilot**, accelerated scripting and test scaffolding
- **GPT**, drafting, summarisation, edge-case generation
- **n8n**, agentic workflow automation
- **Gamma.app**, async-first slide decks and stakeholder briefs

§ TECHNICAL ENVIRONMENT

Shipped with, not just listed.

Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Helm, GitOps, Docker, Jenkins, CI/CD, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin (Spring Boot), Django, SQL, Azure DevOps, GitLab, Matomo, MicroStrategy, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

§ SIDE PROJECT

CONSTRUCT8 [GITHUB.COM/HILBERTP](https://github.com/HilbertP) →

Two-sided B2B marketplace matching construction firms with workers, built solo from zero.

- Anonymity-until-payment model that protects both sides until commitment is confirmed.
 - WhatsApp and Telegram as the primary product surface, removing app-install friction entirely.
 - LLM agents across the funnel so one operator runs the full day-to-day.
 - Directly maps to Customer.io's self-serve motion: conversion, activation, and reducing time-to-value with minimal human intervention.
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§ HOW I WOULD WORK AT CUSTOMER.IO

First weeks, concrete.

WEEK 1

Listen, map, find the gaps.

Shadow support tickets and CX call recordings alongside the data, map the signup-to-activation funnel end to end, and mark every step where drop-off exceeds expectation or where qualitative signal contradicts the metric.

WEEK 2

Slice, hypothesise, prioritise.

Narrow the friction map to the two or three highest-leverage intervention points, draft experiment hypotheses with clear success metrics, and align with Engineering and Design on scope before anything moves to a ticket.

WEEK 3+

Ship, measure, iterate.

Run the first A/B test to production, track activation and conversion deltas against baseline, feed findings back into the roadmap, and close the loop with Marketing and CX on any cross-touchpoint implications.

I COVER LETTER

Dear Megan,

Over ten years of B2B SaaS product ownership, the pattern I keep returning to is this: the gap between a customer signing up and a customer succeeding is almost never a feature gap. It is a clarity gap, a moment where the product asks something of the user that the user was not yet ready to answer. Closing that gap is what I find most interesting in product work, and it is the core of what this role asks.

At CLINET Platforms I inherited a three-person team facing a roadmap it could not deliver. Rather than negotiate timelines, I cut the roadmap to the top ten percent of features and put the released energy into watching how hospital staff actually moved through the app. The result was more than a fivefold increase in user acceptance, not because we built more, but because what remained was finally coherent. At Rohde & Schwarz I ran the same discovery instinct in a different register: I pushed my way into customer workshops, instrumented two competing workflows, and found that the polished UI-led path recorded exactly zero clicks. Redirecting the product toward what people actually used was the unglamorous decision, and it was the right one.

At Customer.io the self-serve journey is where that instinct compounds most visibly. The behavioral data is already there; the experimentation infrastructure is already there. What the role requires is someone who can read the signal honestly, frame a testable hypothesis, and work across Marketing, CX, and Engineering without losing the thread. I have done all three, most recently building construct8, a two-sided B2B marketplace, solo, where I had no choice but to hold discovery, prioritisation, and delivery in a single hand and use LLM agents to keep the operational overhead low enough to stay focused on the product.

I am remote and async-first by default, comfortable presenting to senior stakeholders in English, and available on four weeks' notice. I would welcome a conversation about the specific surfaces you are focused on and the experiments already in flight.

Best regards, *Philipp Hilbert*

II CURRICULUM VITAE

§ BEARING

Product manager with thirteen years of end-to-end product ownership, six of them in B2B SaaS. I run continuous discovery, translate strategy and user needs into a prioritised roadmap, and lead cross-functional teams through agile delivery. My strongest ground is finding and closing the gap between user intent and product experience, through instrumentation, disciplined experimentation, and honest prioritisation rather than feature accumulation.

§ WHAT I CAN DO

Product Management: continuous discovery, product vision and roadmap, prioritisation, MVP definition, A/B testing, user research and interviews, prototyping, funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, go-to-market support.

Product Ownership: requirements engineering, user stories, acceptance criteria, backlog refinement, sprint planning, UAT, velocity tracking, Jira, Confluence, Figma, Miro.

Analytics and Data: funnel and churn analysis, KPI definition, Matomo, MicroStrategy, ETL, Dagster, dbt, PostgreSQL.

Agile and Scaled Delivery: Scrum, Kanban, SAgile, ART, PI planning.

Stakeholder and Leadership: stakeholder management, cross-functional team leadership, C-level reporting, workshop facilitation, conflict resolution.

AI Products and Tooling: LLM agents, agentic workflows, prompt and context engineering, evaluation loops, human-in-the-loop design, AI governance, EU AI Act, Explainable AI; prototyping with Claude Code, GitHub Copilot, Cursor, Lovable.

Technical Environments Owned: Kubernetes, ArgoCD, Docker, GitOps, CI/CD, Jenkins, Git, GitLab, Azure DevOps, REST APIs, Python, Kotlin, Django, SQL, PostgreSQL, MongoDB, Kafka.

Governance: GDPR, Deputy IT Security Officer, identity management, budget ownership.

§ PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

ROHDE & SCHWARZ · PRODUCT MANAGER · DEFENCE AI 2024 TO 2025

Introduced GitOps delivery with ArgoCD across a multinational team; rollout time fell to 30 minutes and the platform became hotfix-capable. Redirected the product away from a zero-click UI to a developer-code-first design after instrumenting live workflows.

BUNDESAGENTUR FÜR ARBEIT · PRODUCT MANAGER · PUBLIC-SECTOR ANALYTICS 2023 TO 2024

Integrated test automation into the Jenkins pipeline, introduced Dagster and dbt for quarterly imports, migrated bare-metal to containers, and carried a full UI relaunch through the same period. Deputy IT Security Officer.

CLINET PLATFORMS · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE MOBILE 2023

Cut the roadmap to the top 10% of features; user acceptance rose more than fivefold. Implemented the CGM interface myself: digital anamnesis time fell from 30 minutes to 5.

EMIL GROUP · PRODUCT MANAGER · INSURANCE B2B SAAS 2022

Restructured an 18-person delivery organisation into three lean teams; attrition fell from near-total to one departure. Shipped the Claims Center from concept to production, cutting time-to-market for a new insurance product to under a week.

SCHEIDT & BACHMANN · PRODUCT OWNER INTEGRATION · RETAIL AND PAYMENTS 2021 TO 2022

Moved research results to production in a fully SAFe setup across agile release trains and PI planning.

BUNDESDRUCKEREI · INTERIM PRODUCT OWNER · GOVERNMENT DATA 2021

Data structures and identity management for the Robert Koch Institute programmes DIM and DESH.

AOK ITSCARE · PROXY PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTH INSURANCE 2019 TO 2020

Migrated a legacy procurement system to Shopware for three AOK insurers and roughly 20,000 employees; still in production.

ENERCON · PROJECT LEAD · WIND ENERGY 2019

Full site IT modernisation end to end.

WALDBURG-ZEIL KLINIKEN · PRODUCT OWNER · HEALTHCARE CLINICAL
NETWORK 2017 TO 2018

WLAN rollout across nine hospitals.

§ FOUNDER & EARLY-STAGE EXPERIENCE

CONSTRUCT8 · FOUNDER AND PM · CONSTRUCTION STAFFING
MARKETPLACE 2025 TO 2026

Zero-to-one two-sided B2B marketplace, built solo. Anonymity-until-payment model,
WhatsApp/Telegram as product surface, LLM agents across the funnel.

QCRYPT AG · CO-FOUNDER AND PRODUCT OWNER · QUANTUM-SECURE
ENCRYPTION 2016 TO 2021

Shipped a three-layer enterprise security product with a sub-two-minute installation. Later
Chair of the board.

SMART SOIL TECHNOLOGIES · CO-FOUNDER, CDO AND CFO ·
NANOTECHNOLOGY 2018 TO 2021

Took a fertiliser product from laboratory to investor rounds; owned financial planning and
investor reporting.

KVITT PAYMENT SOLUTIONS · FOUNDER AND CFO · FINTECH P2P
PAYMENTS 2013 TO 2018

Built from zero to acquisition; acquired and operated by Sparkasse inside the girocard
ecosystem.

§ LANGUAGES

German, native. English, C2.

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